

Figure 1: Boot from CD and install OS

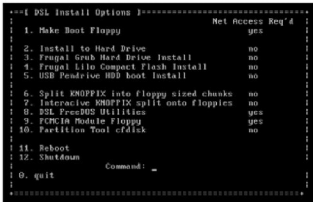


Figure 2: Installation Options Menu

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$KNOPPIX www.knoppix.net -hide-rr-moved -cache-inodes \
-no-bak -pad source/KNOPPIX | nice -5 create_compressed_fs \
- 65536 > master/KNOPPIX/KNOPPIX

$ chmod +x iso-gen.sh
$ sudo ./iso-gen.sh

```

Once you have run these commands, you will get a new file called *stylessen.iso* (as specified in *iso-gen.sh* script) in your current folder.

Before burning this ISO image to disk, if you have a virtualisation solution at your disposal (say, VirtualBox), do test whether or not everything is in order. We can use this ISO image either as a live CD, or install it in our computer. The installation process is as follows:

1. Insert the CD where you burnt the *stylessen.iso* image.
2. A boot menu pops up; in the 'boot:' prompt, type 'install'.
3. You will get a menu that is self-explanatory and has features to partition your disk too.
4. Once the installation is over, reboot the system after removing the CD.
5. Now the system is ready and should ask you to set up the root password.
6. You will also be taken through the steps to configure your X server.
7. Once all the above steps are done, you'll have the new OS. Subsequent reboots will take you directly to the Firefox browser based upon how you have installed the system.

The following figures show a sample installation process and the final screens:

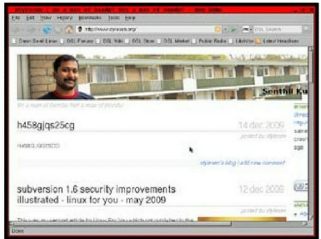


Figure 3: The system after booting



Figure 4: Shut down system after closing Firefox

This is how I made a customised GNU/Linux set up, which I run on a low-profile machine that serves my parents.

A recap

This article explains the basics of setting up an environment to customise Damn Small Linux and walks you through some simple customisation steps. There is a lot more you can customise, which you can explore on your own. If you're running a browsing centre, you can consider this article to roll out your own customised OS which enables you to utilise cheap hardware. **END** 🐧

References

- <http://www.damnsmalllinux.org>
- http://www.knoppix.net/wiki/Knoppix_Remastering_Howto
- <http://ryanlee.org/journal/view/5023/>

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The author is currently employed by CollabNet, working for its Version Control Group. He is a full committer of the Subversion project and is a free software enthusiast. To know more, visit www.stylessen.org.